$$M = \frac{kT^2}{4\pi^2} = \frac{(1150)(0.5)^2}{4\pi^2} = 7.3 kg$$

The gravitational force acting on the body is $W = Mg = 7.3 \times 11.5 = 83.95\ N \approx 84\ N$

10.4.3 Combinations of springs



Figure 10.16 Combination of spring as a shock-absorber in the motor cycle

Spring constant or force constant, also called as stiffness constant, is a measure of the stiffness of the spring.

Larger the value of the spring constant, stiffer is the spring. This implies that we need to apply more force to compress or elongate the spring. Similarly, smaller the value of spring constant, the spring can be stretched (elongated) or compressed with lesser force.

Springs can be connected in two ways. Either the springs can be connected end to end, also known as series connection, or alternatively, connected in parallel. In the following subsection, we compute the effective spring constant when

a. Springs are connected in series
b. Springs are connected in parallel

a. **Springs connected in series**

When two or more springs are connected in series, we can replace (by removing) all the springs in series with an equivalent spring (effective spring) whose net effect is the same as if all the springs are in series connection. Given the value of individual spring constants k_1, k_2, k_3,... (known quantity), we can establish a mathematical relationship to find out an effective (or equivalent) spring constant k_s (unknown quantity). For simplicity, let us consider only two springs whose spring constant are k_1 and k_2 and which can be attached to a mass m as shown in Figure 10.17. The results thus obtained can be generalized for any number of springs in series.

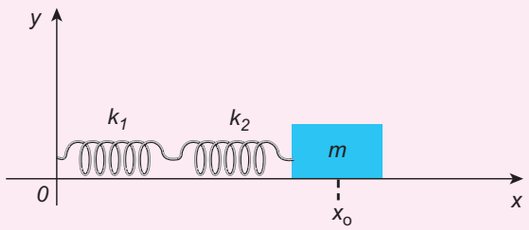


Figure 10.17 Springs are connected in series

Let F be the applied force towards right as shown in Figure 10.18. Since the spring constants for different spring are different and the connection points between them is not rigidly fixed, the strings can stretch in different lengths. Let x_1 and x_2 be the elongation of springs from their equilibrium position (un-stretched position) due to the applied force F. Then, the net displacement of the mass point is

$$x = x_1 + x_2 \qquad (10.37)$$

From Hooke's law, the net force

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